RoboCall AI

User guide — setting it up, sending a campaign, reading the results

27 October 2026 · Covers the dashboard as it currently ships

Start here. Run *python -m uvicorn server:app --port 8000* and open *http://localhost:8000*. Everything is configured from the **Settings** page — there is no configuration file you have to edit. If you only want to hear what this sounds like, skip to section 3: it takes one click and costs about a cent.

1 Before you begin

The application does not place calls itself — it drives a Telnyx account. Four things have to exist on that account before anything will dial, and Telnyx will not tell you clearly which one is missing.

What	Where	Cost
A funded balance	Telnyx portal → Billing. Outbound minutes bill against it and the account refuses to dial at zero.	your choice
An API key	Portal → API Keys → Create API Key	free
A TeXML application	Portal → Voice → TeXML Applications. On its **Outbound** tab attach an **outbound voice profile** — without one the application cannot dial.	free
A voice-capable number	Portal → Numbers → Search & Buy. Assign it to the TeXML application.	about $1 up front, then $1/month

Telnyx has no *verified caller ID* shortcut. The number you call from must be one you actually own on the account — you cannot present a Google Voice number or a mobile you own elsewhere.

Set a spend limit while you are in the portal. On the outbound voice profile, set a **daily spend limit** and restrict destinations to the countries you actually call. This is the only control that stops a mistake at a few dollars instead of the whole balance. Nothing in this application can substitute for it.

2 Settings, field by field

Anything you enter here is stored in the local database and takes precedence over environment variables. Secrets are never sent back to the browser once saved — the field shows blank but reads *set*, and leaving it blank when you save means *leave it alone*, not *erase it*.

Telnyx

Field	What to put in it
API key	The key from the portal. Starts with *KEY*.
TeXML application ID	The long numeric ID of the TeXML application, not its name.

Field	What to put in it
Call from this number	Your **primary** Telnyx number in +1XXXXXXXXXX form. Without rolling calls, this is the caller ID every call shows.
More numbers to call from	Extra Telnyx numbers for **rolling calls** (section 4), each with an optional label such as *Austin*. Four rows are offered and **+ Add another caller number** adds more. Each must be a voice number on the same account, assigned to the same TeXML application. Each row shows its calls and blocks over the last 30 days.
My test number	Your own mobile, so the *Call me now* button has a default target.
Test connection	Press this before anything else. It reports the account, **the balance**, and whether the From number and every rolling number are usable — an empty balance is the most common reason a correct setup still will not dial.

Caller identity

Field	What to put in it
Business name	Prepended to every script as *"This is an automated message from …"*. Leave it blank only if your message already names you — the law requires the identification either way.
Opt-out callback number	Read aloud at the end of every call as the number to ring to be removed. A number that takes voicemail is ideal: it gives you a dated record of each request.

Calling rules

Field	Default	What it does
Don't call before / after	09:00 / 20:00	Local time **at the recipient**, derived from their area code — not your time. Deliberately tighter than the federal 08:00–21:00 limit, because several states are stricter.
Calls per minute	12	Pace, not a speed limit to max out. Bursts are how a number gets labelled *Spam Likely*.
Ring for (seconds)	50	How long to let it ring before giving up. Voicemail usually answers after 25–35 seconds, so calls meant to leave a voicemail always ring for at least 45. Telnyx enforces 5–120 and the app clamps to that range.

Delivery mode

Leave **Public base URL** blank and the app runs in **direct mode**: the whole script travels with the dial request, and nothing on your machine has to be reachable from the internet. That is what lets this run on a laptop. Fill it in with a public HTTPS address for this server — an ngrok tunnel is the usual way — and it switches to **webhook mode**, which additionally allows press-9-to-opt-out, hanging up on voicemail, and live status updates instead of polling.

> If you are running **telemarketing** rather than purely informational calls, direct mode is very likely not lawful on its own — the FCC requires an automated key-press opt-out, which direct mode cannot provide. See the compliance briefing.

3 Your first call

On the **Dashboard**, find the **Test call** card. *Number to call* is pre-filled from your test number. Leave *Message* blank to use a stock script, or type one. Press **Call me now**.

- It ignores quiet hours, because you are deliberately calling yourself.
- It ignores *Pause all calling*, for the same reason.
- It dials with answering-machine detection **off**, so the script starts the instant you answer. This matters: with detection on, a live "hello" is often misread as a machine and the script is withheld while it waits for a greeting that never comes.
- It never dials anyone from a campaign queue alongside it.

The call appears in the **Call log** within a few seconds with the Telnyx call ID. If it fails, the reason is written in the **Activity** feed on the dashboard in plain language rather than as a carrier error code.

4 Building a campaign

New campaign walks through three steps.

1 · What to say

Field	Notes
Campaign name	For your reference only; recipients never hear it.
Brief → **Draft with AI**	Optional. One line in — *"Memorial Day sale starts Friday, 20% off"* — and Claude writes a compliant script. Needs an Anthropic API key in Settings; everything else works without it.
Message the voice will read	The body. Your words, edited freely.
What the recipient actually hears	A live preview of the **final** script: your message with the identification line prepended and the opt-out line appended, plus its spoken length. Read this before you send — it is what actually goes out.
Voice	Neural voices via AWS Polly, plus Telnyx's own cheaper engines.
If an answering machine picks up	*Wait for the beep, leave the message* (default) · *Start talking immediately* · *Hang up*, which needs webhook mode.

2 · Who to call

Paste numbers in any format, or use **Import a CSV file** — you can also drag a file straight onto the field. Everything normalises to E.164. Before you submit, a counter reports how many numbers are callable, how many duplicates were folded together, and which lines could not be read at all, so a malformed list never silently becomes a short one.

3 · When to call

Frequency is once, hourly, daily or weekly. **Time of day** and **Day** apply in the **schedule timezone** you choose — that is when the campaign *fires*. It is a separate thing from the calling window, which is enforced per recipient in *their* timezone. A campaign that fires at 08:00 Eastern will still hold its California numbers until the window

opens there.

Begins and **Ends** bound the whole campaign. Both are optional and both are read in the schedule timezone you picked, so *5 October, 16:00* means 16:00 there, not 16:00 UTC.

Field	What it does
Begins	Nothing is dialled before this moment. Leave it blank and the campaign starts at its first scheduled slot. This is how you set something up on Tuesday that should not call anyone until Monday.
Ends	The campaign retires itself once the next run would fall past this. Leave it blank and a recurring campaign **never stops on its own** — it keeps calling, and keeps billing, until you pause it. The form warns you when you leave it empty.

> **Set an end date.** A daily campaign to 50 people costs about $15 over 30 days. With no end date that same campaign has no upper bound at all — it just keeps going. The $2/day cap on your Telnyx profile will eventually stop it, but by running out of money, which is a bad way to find out.

A campaign whose end has already passed, or whose end falls before its first slot could come round, is rejected when you save it rather than created as something that can never fire.

Rolling calls

Switch on **Rolling calls** at the bottom of *When to call* and a box opens, filled with every number in Settings — the primary and the extra ones. Delete any this campaign shouldn't use. From then on each call goes out from one of those numbers, picked at random, and the app keeps track of which numbers each person has blocked.

When this happens	What the app does
A call goes out	Picks one of the campaign's numbers at random.
The call is blocked	Reads the code the call ended on: **607** (the person marked it unwanted), **608** (a carrier's call filter blocked it) or **603** (declined — and the code US carriers now send, as *603+*, when their analytics block a call). That number is never used for that person again. Their **next** call — the next scheduled run, or *Run now* — comes from a different one.
They block a second number	They are not called again, by any campaign, from any number. The call log says *Blocked 2 of your numbers*.
Many people block the same number	Its block count climbs in Settings. That number is labelled as spam somewhere; replace it, and see below before you do.

Two kinds of block can't be seen. An iPhone set to block you, or to silence unknown callers, sends the call quietly to voicemail — it looks like an ordinary voicemail. A Spam Likely label that still lets the phone ring isn't a block either.

Why it doesn't call straight back from another number

The obvious move after a block is to ring the person again at once from a different number. Rolling calls deliberately doesn't. Carriers' spam filters are built to catch exactly that, and doing it tends to get the new number labelled as well — so you lose two numbers instead of one, and still don't reach the person.

- **The carriers' filters judge the caller, not one number.** Calls to US mobiles are scored before the phone rings by call-analytics companies — Hiya for AT&T, First Orion for T-Mobile, TNS for Verizon. They look at

behaviour: how many calls, how short, how often people reject them, and where they come from.

- **Switching numbers is a known spammer signature.** Hiya reports that more than half of the illegal robocall campaigns it observes rotate numbers, and a large share of unwanted calls come from numbers it has never seen before. A fresh number therefore starts with little trust, and *new number, same network, same calling pattern* is precisely the pattern these engines look for.
- **Your numbers are easy to link.** Every call is signed by Telnyx under STIR/SHAKEN and arrives from the same network with the same script and timing. A call from a new number, to someone who rejected your other number minutes earlier, ties the two together — it doesn't look like a different caller, it looks like the same one hiding.
- **A block is evidence they collect.** When a person marks a call as unwanted (SIP 607), the network can pass that to the analytics engine as a report against the caller. A second call straight after adds a second report, now against both numbers.
- **Wrongly blocked numbers have a proper fix.** A carrier that blocks a call by analytics has to tell the caller — that is the 608 or 603+ code the app reads — and the notice carries a contact for disputing it. Redress clears the number; a replacement usually buys only a short reprieve before it is labelled too.

So the app waits for the next scheduled call before using a different number, switches once per person, and stops if a second number is blocked too. Someone who blocks two of your numbers has made themselves clear — and since the FCC lets people withdraw consent by any reasonable means, they may also have withdrawn it. Spreading ordinary calls across several numbers is still worth doing: each number carries less volume, which is one of the things the filters count.

> **If a number keeps getting blocked**, slow the pace and check consent first. Then register every number you call from, free, at **FreeCallerRegistry.com** — one form that sends them to Hiya, First Orion and TNS together — and dispute the label through the contact in the carrier's block notice. Buying more numbers to replace blocked ones is the slowest way out.

5 Watching it run

A campaign firing does not place every call at once. It writes one row per contact to a queue that a background engine drains at the configured pace. That engine lives inside the server process, so calls continue whether or not a browser is open — closing the tab does not stop a campaign. Only **Pause all calling** does.

On the dashboard	What it tells you
Calls in the last 24 hours	Volume, with the all-time figure underneath.
Delivered	Share of attempts that connected and played.
Waiting to dial	Queue depth right now, including calls held for quiet hours.
Engine	Whether the loop is alive, when it last ticked, and the delivery mode.
Next scheduled runs	What fires next, and when.
Activity	A plain-language feed: campaigns created, calls failed and why.

6 Reading the call log

Every attempt, with the number it came from (**From**) and the carrier's own call ID so it can be traced in the Telnyx portal. *Blocked by the recipient* in the outcome filter shows only the calls that were turned away.

Status	Meaning
Delivered	Connected and the script played.
Delivered + *voicemail* pill	Connected and answering-machine detection reported a machine. Worth checking early on: a live answer misread as a machine is the classic cause of a recipient hearing nothing.
No answer / Busy	Rang out or was engaged. Nothing was spoken.
Failed	The carrier rejected it. The reason is in the Detail column.
suppressed	On the do-not-call list, so it was never dialled.
machine-skipped	*Hang up* mode was set and a machine answered.
opted-out	The recipient pressed 9 during the call. Webhook mode only.
Blocked by their carrier · **Blocked – marked unwanted** · **Declined or blocked**	The call was turned away (SIP 608, 607 or 603). **From** shows which number; a rolling campaign uses a different one for that person next time.
Blocked 2 of your numbers	Never dialled: this person had already blocked two of your numbers.

7 The do-not-call list

The **Do not call** page holds numbers that will never be dialled, whatever a campaign says. Screening happens at dial time, not at import time, so adding a number mid-campaign stops the calls that have not gone out yet — a late opt-out is honoured rather than queued behind an already-built list.

Numbers arrive here three ways: you add them by hand, a recipient presses 9 during a call (webhook mode), or you import them in bulk. **You are legally required to keep this list and to honour requests made by any reasonable means** — including ones that reach you by voicemail on your callback number, which this app cannot see. Those you must enter yourself.

8 The Documents page

Documents, just above Settings in the sidebar, lists every PDF in the project's *docs* folder — this guide, the compliance briefing, and the status reports — with its size and when it was last built. Press **Read** and it opens in the page; **Open in a new tab** gives you the browser's full PDF viewer, printing and saving included.

The list is read from disk each time you open the page, so a PDF you rebuild appears immediately — use **Refresh** if you rebuilt one while the page was already open. Only PDFs sitting directly in that folder are served, and nothing outside it can be reached through this page.

9 When something goes wrong

Symptom	AImost always
Nothing dials at all	The balance is zero, or the TeXML application has no outbound voice profile. Press **Test connection** — it names which.
The call connects but is silent	Answering-machine detection held the script. Set *Start talking immediately*, or check the voicemail pill in the call log.
Calls sit in *Waiting to dial*	It is outside the recipient's calling window. They will go when it opens — check the window in Settings, and remember it is their local time.
Pressing 9 does nothing	You are in direct mode, which cannot receive a keypress. Set a public base URL.
Handsets show *Spam Likely*	A reputation problem, not a bug. Slow the pace, keep volumes modest, and register your numbers at FreeCallerRegistry.com. Rolling calls spreads volume across numbers, but switching numbers to get round a label backfires — the filters watch for exactly that (section 4).
Calls from one rolling number all fail	It isn't assigned to the TeXML application, or isn't on the account. **Test connection** checks every rolling number and says which.
The database looks empty or reverted	It must not live on a synced drive. Dropbox replaces files underneath a running app. Settings shows the path in use.

> **Verify without spending anything.** *python smoke_test.py* and *python pressure_test.py* run 607 checks against a fake carrier. They need no credentials and place no calls, so there is never a reason not to run them after a change.